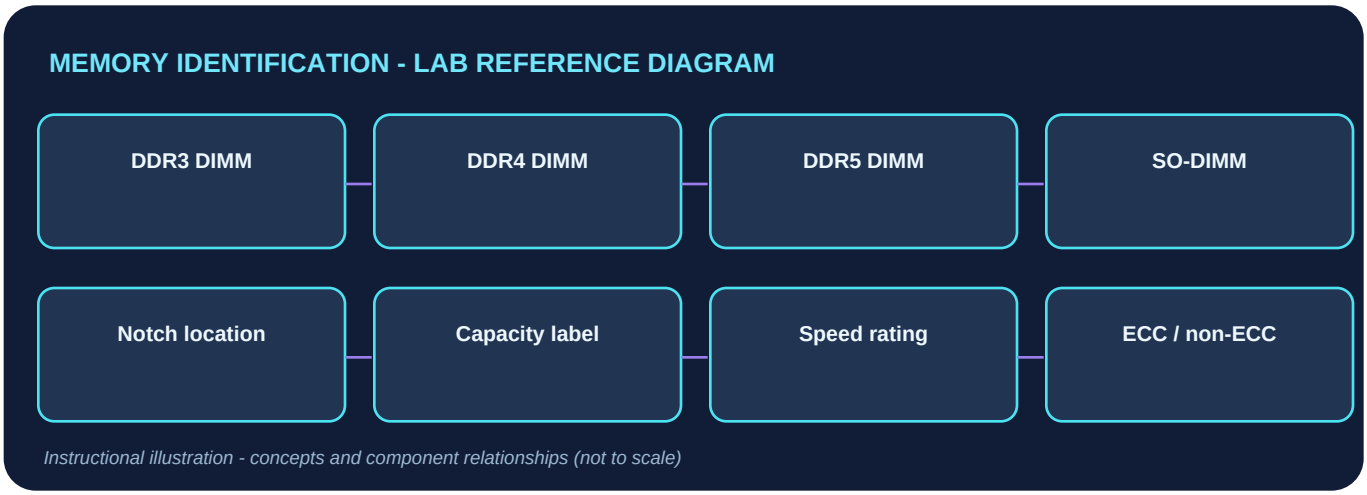
3.3.4 Select Memory by Sight

STUDENT STUDY GUIDE + VOCABULARY + VISUAL REFERENCE

Learning goal

Identify compatible RAM and memory types.

Reference image



Use the labeled illustration to identify the key components, commands, or checkpoints you will encounter in this lab.

Prepare for the simulation

1. Read the module label and identify generation and form factor.
2. Compare notch positions; never force RAM into a slot.
3. Check board and CPU memory compatibility.
4. Verify recognized capacity in BIOS/UEFI.

Troubleshooting and safe practice

• Unmatched notch: stop and identify correct generation.

• Memory not recognized: reseat and check slot/population rules.

3.3.4 | VOCABULARY & REVIEW

Essential vocabulary

Term	Meaning / recognition cue
DDR3 DIMM	Memory characteristic or configuration item; check motherboard support and installation requirements.
DDR4 DIMM	Memory characteristic or configuration item; check motherboard support and installation requirements.
DDR5 DIMM	Memory characteristic or configuration item; check motherboard support and installation requirements.
SO-DIMM	Compact memory form factor common in laptops and small systems.
Notch location	A key term in memory identification; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
Capacity label	A key term in memory identification; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
Speed rating	A key term in memory identification; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.
ECC / non-ECC	A key term in memory identification; identify its purpose, where it is used, and how to verify it.

Knowledge check - answer in your own words

1. Identify two components or commands in the reference diagram and explain what each does.

2. What should you verify before changing or installing hardware, settings, or files in this lab?

3. Choose one listed failure symptom. What is your first safe diagnostic step?

4. How will you prove the task is complete, rather than merely assuming success?

Lab readiness checklist

[ ] I can identify the labeled reference items. [ ] I understand the safety precautions.

[ ] I can explain the vocabulary. [ ] I can verify and document successful results.

Student: _____ Date: _____